

Informational Interview Guide

FOR THE STUDENT

How to ask an adult about their job without it being awkward — including the exact message to send, and questions worth their twenty minutes.

When: Whenever you meet someone doing work you are curious about

The message

A version that works: "Hello — I am a junior at _____ High School and I am interested in _____. I saw that you work as a _____. Would you be willing to talk for 15 minutes about what your job is really like? I am not asking for a job or an internship, just to hear about the work. I can call whenever suits you."

People I could ask (family, neighbours, my parents' colleagues, alumni, my dentist):

Questions worth asking

Tick the ones you will use. Do not read all of them — pick six.

- ☐ What did you actually do yesterday?
- ☐ How did you end up in this job?
- ☐ What do people get wrong about this work?
- ☐ What is the part nobody warns you about?
- ☐ What would you tell someone my age who wants to do this?
- ☐ Is the degree necessary, or is it just the usual route?
- ☐ What does someone earn starting out, realistically?
- ☐ Who else should I talk to?

What they said

Afterwards

- ☐ I sent a thank-you message within two days
- ☐ I wrote down what surprised me while it was fresh
- ☐ I asked who else I should talk to — and I contacted them

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ People like talking about their work. The ask is far less awkward than it feels.
- ◆ Fifteen minutes is an easy yes. An hour is not.
- ◆ Always end by asking who else you should speak to. That is how one conversation becomes five.